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SOCIAL CONCEPTS IN EDUCATION

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LECTURE 1 SOCIOLOGY: AN INTRODUCTION

Learning Objectives

At the end of this chapter, you should be able to:

1. Discuss the origins of sociology, from a historical perspective.
2. Explain why sociology emerged as a discipline
3. Define the term sociology, giving the original and the modern definitions.
4. List the branches which comprise sociology.
5. Give the concepts, issues or concerns that make up the subject matter of sociology.
6. Explain what is meant by the „Sociological Perspective“ and discuss its role in social concerns

1.1 Definition of Sociology

Sociology is the study of human society, its structures, and the interactions within it. It examines how social institutions, relationships, and behaviours develop, function, and change over time. Sociologists explore a wide range of topics, including social norms, values, culture, social stratification, and social problems

Definition of related Terms

- (a) SOCIAL: Refers to anything associated with or part of human society. It encompasses interactions, relationships, and structures within a community.
- (b) SCIENTIFIC: In this context, it refers to research procedures that follow the methods of natural sciences. Sociology, as a social science, uses these methods to study social issues and questions systematically.
- (c) SCIENCE: A discipline characterised by a significant body of knowledge developed through unbiased, systematic research. It includes theories, concepts, principles, and facts. Sociology is considered a science because it follows these principles, allowing for the modification or rejection of incorrect information in favour of more reliable evidence.
- (d) HUMAN GROUPS: Sociology studies collections of individuals rather than single persons. It examines behaviours, activities, and issues within groups, such as organisations or school children, to understand society as a whole.
- (e) PARADIGM: A set of theories, concepts, methods, and beliefs shared by a scientific community regarding the nature of a discipline. In sociology, this includes the fundamental ideas and approaches used to study social phenomena.
- (f) SOCIAL PHENOMENA: Refers to occurrences, events, structures, and behaviors observable in human society. Examples include social institutions, relationships, cultural traditions, and changes within society.

1.2 Reasons why Sociology emerged as a discipline

Sociology emerged in the 19th century due to several key factors that highlighted the need for a new discipline to analyse human societies more effectively than existing fields like philosophy, history, and religion¹²³. Here are some of the main reasons:

- 1 Inadequacy of Older Disciplines:** Traditional disciplines were seen as insufficient in explaining social phenomena. For example, philosophy was often too abstract and not easily understood by the general public
 - 2 Intellectual Shifts:** Prominent thinkers like Auguste Comte, Karl Marx, Max Weber, Emile Durkheim, and Herbert Spencer began focusing on the changes brought by the Industrial Revolution, such as family dynamics, social institutions, and population changes.
 - 3 Industrial Revolution:** The massive social changes caused by the Industrial Revolution, including urbanisation, poor living conditions, and new social problems like poverty and crime, highlighted the need for a discipline that could address these issues from a social perspective¹³.
 - 4 Political and Social Changes:** The French and American revolutions introduced new democratic ideals and social structures, empowering people and creating a need to understand these new social dynamics.
 - 5 Scientific Advancements:** The 19th century saw significant advancements in scientific methods and thinking. This scientific approach influenced the development of sociology, encouraging the use of empirical research and systematic observation to study social phenomena.
 - 6 Urbanisation:** Rapid urbanisation due to the Industrial Revolution led to the growth of cities and new social dynamics. The complexities of urban life, including issues like overcrowding, sanitation, and social stratification, required a new framework for understanding these changes.
 - 7 Economic Changes:** The shift from agrarian economies to industrial economies brought about new economic relationships and class structures. Sociologists sought to understand the implications of these economic transformations on society.
 - 8 Rise of Capitalism:** The rise of capitalism introduced new social and economic challenges, such as labour exploitation, income inequality, and class conflict. These issues prompted sociologists to analyse the impact of capitalism on social relations and institutions.
 - 9 Colonialism and Globalization:** The expansion of European colonialism and the beginnings of globalisation exposed societies to new cultures and social systems. This interaction highlighted the need to study and understand diverse social structures and cultural practices.
 - 10 Educational Reforms:** The 19th century also saw reforms in education, with an increasing emphasis on social sciences. Universities began to establish departments dedicated to the study of society, further legitimising sociology as an academic discipline.
- These conditions paved the way for Auguste Comte to establish sociology as a distinct field, aiming to study human societies through practical observations rather than prescriptive philosophies¹². Comte is often honoured as the “Father of Sociology” for his foundational work in this area¹.

1.3 The Branches of Sociology

Now that you know how to define Sociology, you should also be aware that it is inevitably a diverse discipline so as to address the various social contexts that are part of a given society. Because of the diversity of social the phenomena, Sociology has tried to cover many old and new aspects through a number of branches into which it is subdivided. Some of these are:

- (i) Sociology of Education.
- (ii) Sociology of Religion.
- (iii) Sociology of Social organization.
- (iv) Sociology of knowledge.
- (v) Sociology of law.
- (vi) Sociology of migration.
- (vii) Police Sociology.

- (viii) Military Sociology.
- (ix) Economics Sociology.
- (x) Mathematical Sociology.
- (xi) Urban Sociology. (xii) Rural Sociology.
- (xiii) Sociology of Art.
- (xiv) Sociological Theories.

And the list goes on. Some of these branches are very obscure, but one notable sociologist, Emile Durkheim, once remarked that there are as many branches of Sociology as there are varieties of social facts in human societies.

1.4 Concerns of Sociology

Each of the named factors to be studied through Sociology is an issue or concern for Sociology. Emile Durkheim said that in order to understand the variety of concerns in the social reality of a human society, sociologists should always use a sociological perspective. By this he meant that if we, as sociologists, wanted to understand any issue, question or problem in society, sociologically, we should always use a particular way of looking, viewing, analyzing and finally explaining the social concerns. Sociology is concerned with understanding and analyzing various aspects of human society and social behavior. Here are some of the primary concerns of sociology:

1 Social Structures: Examining the organized patterns of social relationships and social institutions that make up society, such as family, education, religion, and government

2 Socialisation: Understanding how individuals learn and internalize the norms, values, and behaviors necessary to participate in society. **Social Position, Status, and Role:**

Social Position: The place or rank of a person within the social hierarchy, often determined by factors like occupation, education, and family background.

Status: The social honor or prestige attached to a person's position within society. It can be ascribed (assigned at birth) or achieved (earned through actions).

Role: The set of behaviors, responsibilities, and expectations associated with a particular social position. Roles guide how individuals should behave in specific contexts⁴⁵.

3 Social Inequality: Investigating the causes and consequences of social inequalities based on class, race, gender, and other factors.

4 Social Mobility: Refers to the movement of individuals, families, or groups through a system of social hierarchy or stratification. It can be vertical (moving up or down the social ladder) or horizontal (moving within the same social level). Social mobility reflects changes in social status relative to one's current social position

5 Social Change: Studying the processes and factors that drive changes in society, including technological advancements, social movements, and cultural shifts.

6 Social Interaction and Relationship:

Social interaction refers to the ways in which people respond to one another in social situations. It includes communication, cooperation, conflict, and negotiation.

Social relationships are the connections between individuals formed through repeated interactions, which can be based on kinship, friendship, work, or other social bonds..

7 Culture: Exploring the shared beliefs, values, norms, and practices that define different societies and influence social behavior.

8 Deviance and Social Control: Investigating behaviors that violate social norms and the mechanisms societies use to regulate and control deviant behavior.

9 Social Institutions: Examining the major institutions that organize society, such as the economy, education, family, politics, and religion, and their impact on individuals and groups¹.

10 Social Problems: Identifying and analyzing societal issues such as poverty, crime, and discrimination, and exploring potential solutions.

11 Globalization: Understanding the impact of global interconnectedness on societies, including cultural exchanges, economic dependencies, and social change

The society and culture

The society
A configuration of human beings which is capable of providing effective ways and means of development, communication, roles, responsibilities, and the learning opportunities for the mental, physical, moral and spiritual growths of all the members.

The culture

In 1902, Sir Edward B. Taylor, a British Anthropologist (one who studies culture) was the first person to define culture. He defined it as ,that complex whole which includes knowledge, belief, art, morals, laws, customs and any other capabilities and habits acquired by man as a member of society. In 1950, another enthusiast, Edward B. Reuter, defined culture as the sum total of human creation which included what man has made in form of tools, weapons, shelter material goods, attitudes, beliefs, judgement, institutions, arts, sciences, philosophy and social organisation up to the present time.

Other factors we use to characterize the concept of culture are that culture is (i)Organic;

meaning that it belongs to living human beings.

(ii)Supra-organic; meaning that it continues to exist beyond an individual's life-time.

(iii)Not static; meaning that culture is subject to changes, either all or some parts; it can be modified, absorb from other cultures.

(iv)Stable; meaning that culture contains things that people want to hold on to and pass them on, e.g. greetings.

(v)Overt; meaning that culture is comprised of observable items, for example, foods, houses and buildings, types of clothes schools, hospitals, roads, farms and types of crops and so on.

(vi)Covert; meaning that culture is comprised of unobservable elements, like ideas, opinions, beliefs and attitudes that we cannot look and see directly.

They are hidden to our senses until someone tells you what he or she believes in or what his/her thoughts, opinions ideas are.

(vii) Explicit; meaning that culture has actions or activities that can be explained, for example an education system, a political system, laws etc.

(viii) Implicit; meaning that culture contains things we do but are unable to explain why we do them. For example, a group of people would stand talking in the middle of a busy walkway in a big city like Nairobi, blocking it without caring whether others can find their way through.

(ix)Manifest; meaning that culture contains things that people actually do, recognized and are seen by others, for example a wedding ceremony

(x)Ideal; meaning that culture has the ways that members of society ought to do or belief they ought to do; for example we ought to educate our children and believe that we should obey the laws of the country.

	Society	Culture
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Definition	Refers to a group of people who share a common lifestyle, territory, and organisation.	The set of beliefs, practices, learned behaviours, and moral values that are passed on from one generation to another
Scope	Refers to a group of people who share a common lifestyle, territory, and organisation.	Encompasses the shared beliefs, values, customs, and practices within a society ¹³ . Components
Components	Includes people and their social relationships.	Includes beliefs, values, norms, symbols, and artifacts
Function	Provides the structure and framework for social interactions.	Guides the way people live and interact within that structure ³ .
Change	Can change through migration, political shifts, and social movements.	Evolves over time due to social, political, religious, and historical influences
Existence	Exists as a physical entity with people living together.	Exists as an abstract concept passed down through generations ¹
Influence	Shapes the social framework through pressure and organization.	Unites the social framework through shared values and practices
Diversity	Can include multiple cultures within the same geographical area	Can be specific to a particular group or shared across different societies

Role of Sociological Perspective

Understanding Social Behavior: It helps us understand why people behave the way they do by examining the social contexts in which they live. This includes looking at social structures, institutions, and relationships.

Identifying Social Patterns: Sociologists use this perspective to identify patterns in social behaviour and interactions. This can reveal how societal norms and values influence individual actions and group dynamics.

Challenging Common Sense: The sociological perspective encourages us to question what we take for granted and to look at the underlying reasons for social phenomena. This can challenge stereotypes and assumptions.

Exploring Social Inequality: It helps in understanding the roots and impacts of social inequalities related to race, gender, class, and other factors. This perspective can highlight how power and resources are distributed in society.

Promoting Social Change: By understanding the social forces that shape behavior, sociologists can propose ways to address social issues and promote positive change. This can involve policy recommendations, advocacy, and community work.

Enhancing Self-Awareness: It encourages individuals to see how their personal experiences are connected to larger social processes. This can lead to greater self-awareness and a better understanding of one's place in society.

Fostering Empathy: By examining the lives and experiences of different groups, the sociological perspective fosters empathy and understanding across diverse populations.

Informing Public Policy: Sociological research can inform public policy by providing insights into social problems and suggesting evidence-based solutions.

Improving Institutions: It can help improve institutions like education, healthcare, and the criminal justice system by identifying systemic issues and proposing reforms.

Encouraging Critical Thinking: The sociological perspective promotes critical thinking by encouraging people to look beyond surface-level explanations and consider deeper social influences.

LESSON 2

SOCIOLOGY OF EDUCATION

Learning Objectives

At the end of this chapter you should be able to do the following:

- (i) Define or state the meaning of Sociology of Education.
- (ii) Discuss the origins, development and the role of Sociology of Education
- (iii) Show the issues or concerns, and concepts that Sociology of Education addresses in education.
- (iv) Explain how Sociology and Education are connected.
- (v) Explain why teachers should study and know more about Sociology of Education

2.1 Definition/meaning and Role of Sociology of Education

Dr. Olive Banks emphasised this idea of Sociology of Education being a branch of sociology and not education, in her book (The sociology of Education, 1968). How do we define Sociology of Education? It can be defined as a

„Major and specialized branch of Sociology which systematically and scientifically studies the sociological issues, problems and questions that occur within the education phenomenon“

2.2 Origins and development of Sociology of Education

Emile Durkheim (1858-1917) and his contributions

Emile Durkheim was a Frenchman based in the Department of Science of Education at the Sorbonne University in Paris. While there, Durkheim was the Chairman of this Department and also a lecturer and a trainer of teachers. As a sociologist also, he was able to use this opportunity to show how Sociology and Education could merge. In his contributions, Durkheim theoretically emphasized that Education is

- (i) Social in Origin – meaning that it comes from society.
- (ii) A social thing – that it is owned by society.
- (iii) Social in character – that it reflects the behaviour of society
- (iv) Social in function – that it serves the needs in society.
- (v) A social fact and activity – Full of facts and actions found in society
- (vi) A socialising activity – plays a role in the socialisation process in society.

All these features of education in society needed to be ascertained, not through hearsay and speculations but instead, through the sociological methods of actual observations as recommended by Auguste

Comte. Because of his contributions, Emile Durkheim is often honoured as the „father of Sociology of Education“.

John Dewey was an American who was highly respected, and still is, for his remarkable contributions in many disciplines such as Philosophy, Psychology, Sociology and Education. In his contributions, John Dewey began by getting concerned about the relationship between society and schooling. In his concern he observed that,

(i) The simple community life structures in his society was rapidly becoming complex one as more people migrated from the rural areas to urban areas.

(ii) The school and church, all entrusted with the education of the children could hardly cope with the rapid changes:

The children as learners would be inadequately facilitated to fit in the new urban social life and ways of a rapidly/changing complex society; therefore a growing child risked facing utter confusion as he/she became an adult in an urban environment. Therefore, Dewey saw a problem, assessed it and arrived at a conclusion. He also found a practical solution by suggesting the beginning of a new concept he called „the ideal school: The ideal school would prepare the children to live in the American rapidly changing urban society through

(i) teaching them to develop a social spirit of cooperation in society;

(ii) teaching them ways of eliciting this cooperation in the classroom; showing them the means of bringing the school into a relationship with a child's home and the general life in the neighbourhood. He saw the school as a child's second home, a miniature society in which the needs, hopes and interests of children and the expectations of the larger society would be addressed. In this type of school, the child's social life would be prospered as he/she grows. Ultimately, the society would be more improved. This was John Dewey's contribution to the origin of Sociology of Education.

Sir Fred Clarke (1930s): He emphasised the importance of using sociological knowledge in educational planning to create desirable citizens.

Karl Mannheim (1940s): He viewed education as a tool for societal control and improvement, suggesting its use for social betterment.

W.A.C Stewart (1950s): He proposed integrating basic sociology knowledge into teacher training courses, highlighting the need for educators to understand sociological principles.

Dr. Olive Banks (1968): She argued for the Sociology of Education to be recognized as a distinct branch of sociology, emphasising its importance in the broader sociological landscape.

Ivor Morrish (1975): He stressed the importance of cooperation between sociologists in education and educationists with sociology training, advocating for interdisciplinary collaboration to advance the field.

2.3 The Role Of Sociology of Education

1 Understanding Socialisation: It explores how education helps in the socialisation process, teaching individuals the norms, values, and skills necessary to function in society.

2 Analysing Inequality: Sociologists of education study how factors like class, gender, and ethnicity affect educational outcomes and opportunities, highlighting issues of inequality and suggesting ways to address them.

3 Examining Educational Systems: This field looks at the structure and function of educational systems, from classroom dynamics to national policies, and how these systems influence and are influenced by broader social forces.

4 Influencing Policy: Insights from the sociology of education can inform educational policies and practices, aiming to create more equitable and effective educational environments.

5 Role Allocation: Functionalist perspectives within this field discuss how education sorts individuals into roles within the economy, ensuring that the most talented individuals fill the most important positions.

6 Cultural Transmission: It examines how education transmits culture from one generation to the next, preserving societal heritage and fostering a shared identity.

7 **Social Control:** Education is seen as a means of social control, where schools enforce societal norms and values, contributing to social order and stability.

8 **Innovation and Change:** Sociologists study how education can be a force for innovation and social change, promoting new ideas and critical thinking that can lead to societal progress.

9 **Globalisation:** The field also looks at the impact of globalisation on education, including how global trends and policies influence local educational practices and how education prepares individuals for a globalised world.

10 **Teacher-Student Relationships:** It explores the dynamics between teachers and students, including how these relationships affect learning outcomes and the overall educational experience.

11 **Hidden Curriculum:** Sociologists of education analyse the “hidden curriculum,” which includes the implicit lessons taught in schools about social hierarchies, power structures, and cultural norms. 12 **Educational Reforms:** The field provides insights into the effectiveness of various educational reforms and initiatives, helping to identify what works and what doesn’t in different contexts. 13 **Attainment and Mobility:** The Sociology of Education studies how educational attainment affects social mobility, examining how education can either enhance or limit individuals’ opportunities to improve their social and economic status.

14 **Impact of Technology:** It explores the role of technology in education, including how digital tools and online learning platforms are transforming educational practices and access, and the implications of these changes for different social groups.

15 **Peer Influence:** The Sociology of Education examines how peer groups within educational settings influence behaviours, attitudes, and academic performance, highlighting the importance of social interactions in learning environments.

16 **Parental Involvement:** It studies the role of parents and families in the educational process, including how different levels of parental involvement and support impact student achievement and engagement.

17 **School Climate and Environment:** This field looks at how the physical and emotional climate of schools affects student learning and well-being, including factors like safety, resources, and teacher-student relationships.

18 **Educational Stratification:** Sociologists analyse how educational systems can perpetuate social stratification, examining how *tracking*, *streaming*, and other practices can lead to unequal educational opportunities and outcomes.

19 **Cultural Capital:** The concept of cultural capital is explored, which refers to the non-financial social assets (like education, intellect, style of speech, and dress) that promote social mobility. Sociologists study how access to cultural capital varies among different social groups and its impact on educational success.

20 **Intersectionality:** The field considers how various social identities (such as race, gender, class, and sexuality) intersect and affect educational experiences and outcomes, providing a more nuanced understanding of inequality in education.

2.4 Concerns of Sociology of Education

a) Relationship between a Society and its Education System

Social Reproduction: Education systems often perpetuate existing social inequalities by providing different qualities of education based on social class, race, and gender.

Cultural Transmission: Schools transmit cultural values and norms, which can either reinforce or challenge societal norms.

Social Integration: Education promotes social integration by instilling a sense of national identity and shared values.

Economic Development: The education system is linked to the economy, preparing individuals for various roles in the workforce and contributing to economic growth.

Political Socialisation: Schools play a role in political socialisation, teaching students about civic responsibilities and the functioning of political systems.

Globalisation: The impact of globalisation on education, including how global trends and policies influence local educational practices.

Technological Influence: The role of technology in shaping educational practices and access, and its implications for different social groups.

Policy and Reform: How educational policies and reforms reflect and influence societal values and priorities.

Community Involvement: The relationship between schools and their communities, and how community involvement affects educational outcomes.

Equity and Access: Issues of equity and access to education, and how societal factors influence who gets educated and to what extent¹.

b) Functions and Contributions of Education

- **Socialisation:** Education helps in the socialization process, teaching students the norms, values, and skills needed to function in society.
- **Skill Development:** Schools provide the necessary skills and knowledge required for various professions, contributing to the workforce.
- **Social Control:** Education helps maintain social order by promoting conformity to societal norms and laws.
- **Innovation:** Educational institutions are centres for research and innovation, contributing to societal progress.
- **Social Mobility:** Education can provide opportunities for social mobility, allowing individuals to improve their social and economic status.
- **Cultural Preservation:** Schools play a role in preserving and transmitting cultural heritage and traditions.
- **Critical Thinking:** Education fosters critical thinking and problem-solving skills, essential for personal and societal development.
- **Health and Well-being:** Schools contribute to the physical and mental health of students through health education and support services.
- **Civic Engagement:** Education encourages civic engagement and participation in democratic processes.
- **Economic Benefits:** Higher levels of education are associated with better economic outcomes for individuals and societies.

c) School as a Formal Social Organization

Hierarchical Structure: Schools have a formal hierarchical structure with defined roles and responsibilities for administrators, teachers, and students.

Bureaucratic Procedures: Schools operate with bureaucratic procedures and policies that govern their functioning.

Standardised Curriculum: The curriculum is standardised to ensure uniformity in education across different schools.

Formal Assessment: Schools use formal assessment methods to evaluate student performance and progress.

Institutional Culture: Each school has its own institutional culture that influences the behaviour and attitudes of students and staff.

Resource Allocation: How resources are allocated within schools and the impact on educational quality and equity.

Policy Implementation: The role of schools in implementing educational policies and reforms³.

Accountability: Mechanisms for accountability in schools, including performance evaluations and inspections

Professional Development: Opportunities for professional development for teachers and staff within the school organization.

Community Relations: The relationship between schools and their surrounding communities, including partnerships and collaborations.

d) The Teacher and the Teaching Activity

Role Modelling: Teachers serve as role models, influencing students' attitudes, behaviors, and aspirations.

Pedagogical Methods: The effectiveness of different teaching methods and their impact on student learning.

Teacher-Student Relationships: The quality of relationships between teachers and students affects the learning environment and student outcomes.

Professional Development: Continuous professional development for teachers is essential to keep up with educational advancements and improve teaching quality.

Classroom Management: Effective classroom management strategies are crucial for creating a conducive learning environment.

Instructional Planning: The importance of planning and preparation in delivering effective instruction.

Assessment and Feedback: The role of assessment and feedback in guiding student learning and improving teaching practices.

Teacher Autonomy: The degree of autonomy teachers have in their classrooms and its impact on teaching and learning.

Collaboration: The importance of collaboration among teachers, and between teachers and other stakeholders.

Workload and Stress: Issues related to teacher workload, stress, and job satisfaction. **e)**

The Learner's Learning Environments

Home Environment: The socio-economic status and educational background of a student's family significantly impact their educational outcomes.

Peer Influence: Peer groups within the school environment can influence students' attitudes towards learning and academic performance.

School Resources: Availability of resources such as libraries, laboratories, and technology affects the quality of education.

Learning Styles: Recognizing and accommodating different learning styles and needs is important for effective education.

Extracurricular Activities: Participation in extracurricular activities contributes to the overall development of students and enhances their educational experience.

Classroom Environment: The physical and emotional climate of the classroom affects student learning and well-being.

Teacher Support: The level of support and encouragement from teachers influences student motivation and achievement.

Parental Involvement: The role of parents and families in supporting and enhancing the educational experience.

Community Resources: Access to community resources and support services can enhance the learning environment.

Technology Integration: The use of technology in the learning environment and its impact on student engagement and learning outcomes.

2.5 Impirtance of Sociology of Education to The Teacher

Understanding Student Diversity: Helps teachers understand the diverse backgrounds of their students, including cultural, social, and economic differences, which can inform more inclusive teaching practices.

Addressing Inequality: Provides insights into how social inequalities affect educational outcomes, enabling teachers to develop strategies to support disadvantaged students.

Improving Classroom Management: Offers knowledge about social dynamics and group behavior, which can improve classroom management and create a positive learning environment.

Enhancing Communication: Helps teachers develop better communication skills by understanding the social contexts of their students.

Curriculum Development: Informs the development of curricula that are relevant and responsive to the needs of diverse student populations.

Promoting Social Justice: Encourages teachers to advocate for social justice and equity in education, ensuring all students have access to quality education.

Fostering Critical Thinking: Equips teachers with the tools to foster critical thinking and social awareness among students.

Supporting Professional Development: Provides a framework for continuous professional development by understanding the broader social context of education.

Enhancing Student Engagement: Helps teachers create engaging and relevant lessons by understanding students' social worlds and interests.

Policy Implementation: Assists teachers in understanding and implementing educational policies effectively within their classrooms.

Building Community Relationships: Encourages the development of strong relationships between schools and their communities, enhancing support for students.

Adapting to Change: Prepares teachers to adapt to social changes and trends that impact education, such as technological advancements and globalization.

Evaluating Educational Practices: Provides tools for evaluating and improving educational practices based on sociological research.

Encouraging Inclusivity: Promotes inclusive education practices that respect and value all students' backgrounds and experiences.

Understanding Institutional Roles: Helps teachers understand their role within the larger educational institution and how they can influence positive change.

Developing Empathy: Fosters empathy and understanding towards students' life circumstances, improving teacher-student relationships.

Supporting Student Well-being: Highlights the importance of addressing students' social and emotional needs as part of their overall education.

Facilitating Collaboration: Encourages collaboration with colleagues, parents, and the community to support student learning and development.

Promoting Lifelong Learning: Instills the value of lifelong learning and continuous improvement in teaching practices.

Enhancing Reflective Practice: Encourages teachers to reflect on their own beliefs, biases, and practices, leading to more effective and equitable teaching.

Contributions of Herbert Spencer to the Sociology of Education

- **Social Darwinism:** Spencer applied the concept of "survival of the fittest" to societies, influencing educational thought by promoting competition and individualism.
- **Synthetic Philosophy:** His comprehensive work included volumes on sociology, biology, psychology, and ethics, integrating these fields into educational theory
- **Education:** *Intellectual, Moral, and Physical:* Spencer's book emphasized the holistic development of individuals through education.
- **Natural Process of Mental Evolution:** He viewed education as a natural process that should align with human mental development
- **Individualism:** Advocated for education systems that promote individual rights and personal development
- **Scientific Approach:** Emphasized the importance of scientific knowledge and methods in education.
- **Curriculum Development:** Suggested that the curriculum should include practical and scientific subjects to prepare individuals for real-life challenges.
- **Moral Education:** Stressed the importance of moral education in developing responsible citizens.
- **Critique of Traditional Education:** Criticized rote learning and advocated for education that fosters critical thinking and problem-solving.
- **Role of Teachers:** Viewed teachers as facilitators of learning rather than mere transmitters of knowledge.
- **Educational Reforms:** His ideas influenced educational reforms aimed at making education more relevant to societal needs.
- **Evolutionary Theory:** Applied evolutionary theory to the development of human societies and education systems.
- **Social Progress:** Believed that education plays a crucial role in social progress and the advancement of civilization.
- **Adaptation to Environment:** Argued that education should help individuals adapt to their social and physical environments
- **Holistic Education:** Promoted a balanced approach to education that includes intellectual, moral, and physical development.

- **Empirical Research:** Advocated for the use of empirical research in developing educational theories and practices.
- **Educational Psychology:** Contributed to the development of educational psychology by linking psychological principles to educational practices.
- **Social Self-Consciousness:** Emphasized the development of social self-consciousness through education.
- **Professional Education:** Discussed the role of professional education in preparing individuals for specialized roles in society.
- **Critique of State Intervention:** Criticized excessive state intervention in education, advocating for more autonomy for educational institutions.

Contributions of Auguste Comte to the Sociology of Education

- **Founder of Sociology:** Coined the term “sociology” and established it as a systematic field of study.
- **Positivism:** Advocated for a scientific approach to studying society, which influenced educational research methods.
- **Law of Three Stages:** Proposed that human thought progresses through theological, metaphysical, and positive stages, impacting educational philosophy.
- **Social Statics and Dynamics:** Divided sociology into social statics (forces holding society together) and social dynamics (forces driving social change), which influenced educational theory.
- **Education for Social Harmony:** Believed education should promote social harmony and prepare individuals for their roles in society.
- **Scientific Principles in Education:** Emphasized the importance of basing education on scientific principles.
- **Role of Education in Social Progress:** Saw education as a key factor in advancing society and achieving social progress.
- **Moral Education:** Stressed the importance of moral education in developing responsible citizens.
- **Education and Social Order:** Believed that education helps maintain social order by instilling shared values and norms.
- **Empirical Observation:** Advocated for the use of empirical observation and experimentation in educational research.
- **Education and Social Change:** Viewed education as a tool for driving social change and improving society.
- **Holistic Education:** Promoted a holistic approach to education that includes intellectual, moral, and physical development.
- **Educational Reforms:** His ideas influenced educational reforms aimed at making education more relevant to societal needs.
- **Curriculum Development:** Suggested that the curriculum should include scientific and practical subjects to prepare individuals for real-life challenges.
- **Role of Teachers:** Viewed teachers as facilitators of learning and moral guides.
- **Critique of Traditional Education:** Criticized traditional education methods and advocated for more progressive approaches.
- **Education and Social Integration:** Believed that education helps integrate individuals into society by instilling shared values and norms.
- **Educational Psychology:** Contributed to the development of educational psychology by linking psychological principles to educational practices.

- **Professional Education:** Discussed the role of professional education in preparing individuals for specialized roles in society.
- **Critique of State Intervention:** Criticized excessive state intervention in education, advocating for more autonomy for educational institutions.

Contributions of Emile Durkheim to the Sociology of Education

- **Education and Social Solidarity:** Emphasized the role of education in promoting social solidarity and cohesion.
- **Moral Education:** Stressed the importance of moral education in developing responsible citizens.
- **Education as Socialization:** Viewed education as a key mechanism for socializing individuals into the norms and values of society.
- **Functionalism:** Developed the functionalist perspective, which views education as essential for maintaining social order.
- **Education and Social Integration:** Believed that education helps integrate individuals into society by instilling shared values and norms.
- **School as a Miniature Society:** Argued that schools serve as miniature societies where children learn to interact with others and follow social rules.
- **Specialized Skills:** Emphasized the importance of teaching specialized skills needed for an economy based on a specialized division of labor.
- **Collective Conscience:** Introduced the concept of collective conscience, which refers to the shared beliefs and values that bind society together.
- **Education and Social Facts:** Viewed education as a social fact that influences and is influenced by other social facts
- **Empirical Research:** Advocated for the use of empirical research in developing educational theories and practices
- **Historical Education:** Believed that teaching history helps link individuals to their social past and develop a sense of commitment to the social group.
- **Education and Social Change:** Viewed education as a tool for driving social change and improving society.
- **Critique of Traditional Education:** Criticized traditional education methods and advocated for more progressive approaches.
- **Role of Teachers:** Viewed teachers as moral guides and facilitators of learning.
- **Educational Reforms:** His ideas influenced educational reforms aimed at making education more relevant to societal needs.
- **Curriculum Development:** Suggested that the curriculum should include subjects that promote social solidarity and cohesion.
- **Education and Social Order:** Believed that education helps maintain social order by instilling shared values and norms.
- **Educational Psychology:** Contributed to the development of educational psychology by linking psychological principles to educational practices.
- **Professional Education:** Discussed the role of professional education in preparing individuals for specialized roles in society.
- **Critique of State Intervention:** Criticized excessive state intervention in education, advocating for more autonomy for educational institutions.

Classical Approaches to Sociology of Education Conflict theory

Conflict theory offers valuable insights into the education system in Kenya by highlighting how power dynamics and social inequalities shape educational experiences and outcomes. Here are some key contributions of conflict theory in understanding education and schooling in Kenya today:

1. Highlighting Educational Inequality

Conflict theory emphasizes how education can perpetuate social inequalities. In Kenya, disparities in school funding and resources between urban and rural areas, and between private and public schools, reflect broader socio-economic inequalities.

2. Power Dynamics in Education

The theory sheds light on how the interests of the dominant class influence educational policies and practices. This can be seen in how elite schools often have better facilities and more experienced teachers compared to schools in marginalized communities.

3. Role of the Hidden Curriculum

Conflict theory introduces the concept of the hidden curriculum, where schools implicitly teach students to accept their social positions and the status quo. In Kenya, this can manifest in how students from different backgrounds are socialized into different expectations and roles².

4. Economic Context and Education The theory situates education within the broader economic context, showing how economic inequalities influence access to quality education. For instance, children from wealthier families can afford better educational resources and opportunities¹.

5. Teacher Expectations and Bias

Conflict theory helps explain how teacher expectations and biases can affect student performance. In Kenya, teachers may have lower expectations for students from poorer backgrounds, which can negatively impact their academic achievements.

6. Examination Systems

The theory critiques standardized testing and examination systems for favoring students from privileged backgrounds who have better preparatory resources. This can lead to unequal educational outcomes and reinforce existing social hierarchies.

7. Access to Education

Conflict theory highlights barriers to educational access for children from lower socio-economic backgrounds. In Kenya, factors such as school fees, distance to schools, and the need for children to work can limit access to education.

8. Curriculum Content

The theory critiques the curriculum for often reflecting the interests and values of the elite, rather than addressing the needs and realities of all students. This can result in a disconnect between what is taught in schools and the lived experiences of many Kenyan students.

9. Gender Inequality

Conflict theory helps analyze gender disparities in education, where girls may face additional barriers to schooling due to cultural and economic factors. In Kenya, efforts to address these disparities are ongoing, but challenges remain.

10. Ethnic and Regional Inequalities

The theory provides a framework for understanding how ethnic and regional inequalities impact educational access and quality. In Kenya, certain regions may have less access to quality education due to historical and socio-political factors.

11. Role of NGOs

Conflict theory examines the role of non-governmental organizations (NGOs) in addressing educational inequalities and advocating for policy changes. In Kenya, NGOs play a significant role in providing educational resources and support to marginalized communities.

12. School Funding Disparities

The theory explains how funding disparities contribute to unequal educational opportunities. Schools in wealthier areas receive more resources, leading to better educational outcomes for their students..

13. Vocational Training

Conflict theory highlights the need for vocational training and education that addresses the economic realities of many Kenyan students, rather than a one-size-fits-all academic approach.

14. Parental Involvement

The theory underscores the impact of parental involvement on educational outcomes. In Kenya, parents from higher socio-economic backgrounds are often more involved in their children's education, providing additional support and resources.

15. Community Resources

Conflict theory shows how the availability of community resources, such as libraries and recreational centers, influences educational outcomes. In Kenya, disparities in community resources can affect students' learning experiences.

16. Health and Nutrition

The theory highlights the impact of health and nutrition on educational performance. In Kenya, children from poorer backgrounds may face health and nutritional challenges that affect their ability to learn.

17. Technological Access

Conflict theory explains how access to technology influences educational opportunities. In Kenya, students from wealthier families have greater access to technology, which is increasingly important for modern education.

18. Educational Aspirations

The theory examines how social background influences educational aspirations. In Kenya, children from higher socio-economic backgrounds often have higher educational aspirations and more opportunities to achieve them.

19. Policy Influence

Conflict theory provides insights into how educational policies are influenced by political and economic elites, often sidelining the needs of marginalized communities. In Kenya, this can be seen in the implementation of educational reforms.

20. Future Reforms

Conflict theory encourages ongoing critical analysis and advocacy for educational reforms that aim to reduce inequalities and promote social justice. In Kenya, this involves addressing systemic issues and ensuring that all students have access to quality education².

By applying conflict theory, we gain a deeper understanding of the structural issues within the Kenyan education system and the ways in which it can be reformed to better serve all students.

Functionalist theory

Functionalist theory, primarily associated with Emile Durkheim and Talcott Parsons, provides a framework for understanding how education contributes to the stability and functioning of society. Here

are some key contributions of Functionalist theory in understanding the process of education and schooling in Kenya today:

1. Social Solidarity

Functionalist theory emphasizes the role of education in promoting social solidarity. In Kenya, schools help create a sense of national identity and unity by teaching shared values and cultural heritage.

2. Value Consensus

Education in Kenya fosters value consensus by instilling common norms and values in students. This helps maintain social order and cohesion, as individuals learn to adhere to societal expectations.

3. Role Allocation

Functionalists argue that education sorts individuals into appropriate roles based on their abilities. In Kenya, the education system aims to identify and nurture talents, preparing students for various roles in the economy and society.

4. Meritocracy

The concept of meritocracy is central to Functionalist theory. In Kenya, the education system strives to provide equal opportunities for all students to succeed based on their abilities and efforts, promoting social mobility.

5. Social Integration

Schools in Kenya play a crucial role in integrating diverse ethnic and cultural groups, fostering a sense of belonging and reducing social tensions.

6. Transmission of Culture

Education transmits cultural values and knowledge from one generation to the next. In Kenya, this includes teaching the history, languages, and traditions of various communities, preserving cultural heritage.

7. Skill Development

Functionalist theory highlights the importance of education in developing the skills needed for the workforce. Kenya's education system focuses on equipping students with practical skills through vocational training and competency-based education.

8. Economic Development

Education is seen as a driver of economic development. In Kenya, the government invests in education to build a skilled workforce that can contribute to national development and economic growth.

9. Social Control

Schools help maintain social control by teaching discipline and respect for authority. In Kenya, this is reflected in school rules and regulations that guide student behavior.

10. Innovation and Change

Functionalist theory acknowledges the role of education in promoting innovation and social change. In Kenya, educational reforms, such as the competency-based curriculum, aim to adapt to changing societal needs and global trends.

11. Reduction of Inequality

While Functionalist theory recognizes the role of education in promoting equality, it also acknowledges existing inequalities. In Kenya, efforts are made to reduce educational disparities through policies aimed at increasing access for marginalized groups.

12. Preparation for Citizenship

Education prepares individuals for their roles as active citizens. In Kenya, civic education programs teach students about their rights and responsibilities, encouraging participation in democratic processes.

13. Health and Well-being

Schools contribute to the health and well-being of students by providing health education and promoting healthy lifestyles. In Kenya, school health programs address issues such as nutrition and hygiene.

14. Community Development

Functionalist theory views education as a means of community development. In Kenya, schools often serve as community centers, providing resources and support to local populations.

15. Gender Equality

Education promotes gender equality by providing equal opportunities for boys and girls. In Kenya, initiatives aimed at increasing girls' enrollment and retention in schools are part of broader efforts to achieve gender parity.

16. Environmental Awareness

Schools play a role in raising environmental awareness. In Kenya, environmental education programs teach students about sustainability and conservation.

17. Technological Advancement

Education fosters technological advancement by teaching students about new technologies and their applications. In Kenya, the integration of ICT in education is a key focus area.

18. Global Competitiveness Functionalist theory highlights the role of education in enhancing a country's global competitiveness. In Kenya, educational reforms aim to improve the quality of education and align it with international standards.

19. Social Mobility

Education provides a pathway for social mobility. In Kenya, scholarships and bursaries help students from disadvantaged backgrounds access higher education and improve their socio-economic status.

20. Lifelong Learning

Functionalist theory supports the concept of lifelong learning. In Kenya, adult education programs provide opportunities for continuous learning and skill development throughout life.

These contributions illustrate how Functionalist theory helps us understand the multifaceted role of education in Kenyan society.

Symbolic interactionism approach

Symbolic interactionism, a sociological perspective that focuses on the meanings and interpretations individuals attach to social interactions, offers valuable insights into the education system in Kenya. Here are some key contributions of symbolic interactionism in understanding the process of education and schooling in Kenya today:

1. Role of Symbols in Education

- **Classroom Environment:** The arrangement of desks, use of uniforms, and school rituals are symbols that convey meanings about authority, discipline, and the educational process.
- **Educational Materials:** Textbooks, blackboards, and other educational tools are symbols that shape how students perceive and engage with learning.

2. Importance of Language

- **Communication:** Language is a crucial element in the educational process. It is through language that teachers convey knowledge and students express their understanding.
- **Labels and Expectations:** Terms like "gifted," "average," or "special needs" can significantly influence students' self-perception and their interactions with peers and teacher.

3. Teacher-Student Interactions

- Expectations and Performance: Teachers' expectations can impact student performance. Positive interactions and high expectations can boost student confidence and achievement.
- Feedback and Reinforcement: The way teachers provide feedback and reinforcement can shape students' attitudes towards learning and their self-esteem.

4. Peer Interactions

- Socialization: Schools are primary sites for socialization where students learn social norms and values through interactions with peers.
- Peer Influence: Peer groups can influence students' attitudes towards education, their behavior, and academic performance.

5. Identity Formation

- Self-Concept: Education plays a significant role in the development of students' self-concept. Interactions with teachers and peers help shape their identities and self-esteem.
- Role Models: Teachers and successful peers serve as role models, influencing students' aspirations and career choices.

6. Cultural Context

- Cultural Symbols: In Kenya, cultural symbols and practices are integrated into the education system, helping students connect their learning with their cultural heritage.
- Language of Instruction: The use of local languages alongside English and Kiswahili in schools helps preserve cultural identity while promoting national unity.

7. Social Dynamics in the Classroom

- Group Dynamics: The interactions within the classroom, including group work and discussions, help students develop social skills and learn to work collaboratively.
- Classroom Management: Teachers' strategies for managing classroom behavior reflect and reinforce social norms and expectations.

8. Educational Policies and Practices

- Policy Implementation: The success of educational policies often depends on how they are interpreted and implemented by teachers and administrators at the school level.
- School Culture: Each school develops its own culture based on the interactions and shared meanings of its members, influencing the overall educational experience.

9. Impact of Socio-Economic Background

- Resource Access: Students from different socio-economic backgrounds may interpret and experience education differently based on their access to resources and support.
- Parental Involvement: The level of parental involvement in education can affect students' attitudes and performance, with more involved parents often fostering a positive educational environment.

10. Adaptation to Change

- Curriculum Reforms: The introduction of the competency-based curriculum (CBC) in Kenya requires teachers and students to adapt to new methods and expectations, which are interpreted and negotiated through daily interactions.
- Technological Integration: The use of technology in education is reshaping how students and teachers interact, creating new symbols and meanings in the learning process.

By focusing on the micro-level interactions and the meanings attached to them, symbolic interactionism provides a nuanced understanding of the educational process in Kenya. It highlights how individual experiences and social contexts shape educational outcomes, offering valuable insights for educators, policymakers, and researchers.

LESSON THREE

SOCIOLOGY OF THE SCHOOL: SCHOOL AS A SOCIAL ORGANISATION

Learning objectives

At the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- (1) Define the term formal social organisation.
- (2) Discuss what characteristics a formal social organisation exhibits.
- (3) Examine and illustrate what makes or how the school is conceptualised as a formal social organisation.
- (4) State either,
(i) the school IS a formal social organisation or (ii)
the school is NOT a formal social organisation

3.1 Meaning of a Social Organization

In 1964, Amitai Etzioni viewed organisations as social units which have been designed in society to carry out certain activities towards the fulfillment of their assigned goals. Using our definition and Etzioni's view, we can conclude that organisations by nature are *social since they are structured by, found in and perform activities so as to attain goals in society.* However, organisations do not carry out their activities haphazardly. *Instead, they follow certain prescribed, established and written rules and regulations. This idea makes organizations also formal.* Examples of formal, social organizations include the following: a university, hospital, police force, military, a prison, company, political party, soccer club, and many others.

3.2 Factors Characterizing School as a Formal Social Organization

- 1 Division of Labor:** Tasks are divided among members, each with specific roles and responsibilities.
- 2 Hierarchy of Authority:** A clear chain of command exists, with defined levels of authority.
- 3 Formal Rules and Regulations:** Established rules and procedures guide the organisation's operations.
- 4 Goal Orientation:** The organisation has specific goals and objectives it aims to achieve.
- 5 Impersonal Relationships:** Interactions are based on roles and responsibilities rather than personal relationships.

6 Formal Communication Channels: Communication follows a structured path, often through official channels.

7 Standardised Procedures: Standard operating procedures ensure consistency in operations. **8**

Professionalism: Members are expected to adhere to professional standards and conduct. **9**

Accountability: Clear accountability mechanisms are in place to monitor performance and outcomes.

10 Specialisation: Members often have specialised skills and expertise relevant to their roles.

11 Coordination: Activities are coordinated to ensure that all parts of the organisation work towards common goals.

12 Efficiency: The organisation aims to maximise efficiency in achieving its objectives.

13 Formal Training: Members receive formal training to perform their roles effectively. **14**

Documentation: Policies, procedures, and activities are documented for reference and accountability.

15 Stability and Continuity: The organisation is designed to endure over time, beyond the involvement of specific individuals.

16 Merit-based Advancement: Promotions and advancements are based on merit and

performance. **17 Performance Evaluation:** Regular evaluations assess the performance of members and the organisation as a whole.

18 Formal Membership: Membership is clearly defined, often with specific criteria for joining and leaving.

19 Legal Recognition: The organisation is often legally recognized and operates within a legal framework.

20 Resource Allocation: Resources are allocated systematically to support the organisation's goals.

LESSON 4 THE SCHOOL CLASSROOM

At the end of the chapter, you shall be able to: (1)

Define the term „School classroom;

(2) Cite and discuss the various characteristics of a school classroom.

Cite and discuss Diversity of the classroom catchment Area

4.1 School classroom characteristics 4.1 (a) Presence of the human component

A school classroom is made up of two main social actors, namely, the teacher and the learners, often referred to as the pupils or students. **Roles of the teacher in the classroom**

(1) Instructor

- Knowledge Custodian: Holds and imparts knowledge.
- Deliverer of New Knowledge: Introduces new concepts and skills.
- Facilitator of Learning: Guides and supports the learning process.
- Resource Person: Provides resources and materials for learning.

(2) Evaluator

- Judge of Academic Performance: Assesses student progress and achievements.
- Teaching Effectiveness: Evaluates the effectiveness of teaching methods.
- Adequacy of Materials: Ensures learning materials are appropriate for the students' level.
- Feedback Provider: Offers constructive feedback to improve student performance.

(3) Disciplinarian

- Authority Source: Enforces rules and regulations.
- Behaviour Modifier: Influences and changes student behaviour.
- Reward and Punishment: Determines consequences for adherence or non-adherence to rules.
- Change Agent: Promotes positive behavioural changes.

(4) Group Leader

- Guide: Directs classroom activities and learning.
- Manager: Organises and manages classroom tasks.
- Motivator: Inspires and encourages students to excel.
- Activity Organiser: Plans and coordinates classroom activities.

(5) Mediator/Conciliator

- Consensus Agent: Facilitates agreement and reconciliation among students.
- Conflict Resolver: Addresses and resolves conflicts.
- Decision Maker: Makes fair and acceptable decisions.
- Dialogue Facilitator: Encourages open communication and dialogue.

(5) Advisor

- Behavioural Counsellor: Guides students in changing their behaviour and attitudes.
- Personal Advisor: Offers advice on personal issues and life choices.

- **Listener:** Provides a listening ear for students' concerns.
- **Support Provider:** Supports students in their personal development.

(6) Parent Surrogate

- **Caretaker:** Looks after students' welfare in the absence of their parents.
- **Supportive Figure:** Provides emotional and social support.
- **Role Model:** Acts as a positive role model for students.
- **Guardian:** Ensures students' safety and well-being.

(7) Innovator: The teacher introduces new teaching methods and technologies to enhance learning and keep students engaged.

(8) Cultural Ambassador: The teacher promotes cultural awareness and sensitivity, helping students appreciate and respect diverse perspectives.

(9) Ethical Guide: The teacher instills ethical values and principles, guiding students in making responsible and moral decisions.

(10) Community Liaison: The teacher acts as a bridge between the school and the wider community, fostering partnerships and collaboration.

(11) Lifelong Learner: The teacher continuously updates their own knowledge and skills, modeling the importance of lifelong learning.

(12) Advocate: The teacher advocates for students' needs and rights within the school system, ensuring they receive the support they need to succeed.

(13) Collaborator: The teacher works with other teachers and staff to improve educational outcomes and create a cohesive learning environment.

(14) Planner: The teacher develops lesson plans and educational strategies that align with curriculum goals and student needs.

Evaluator of Resources: The teacher assesses and selects appropriate educational resources to enhance learning.

(15) Inspirational Leader: The teacher inspires students to achieve their full potential and pursue their goals with confidence and determination.

Roles of a Peer

- **Collaborator:** Works together with classmates on projects and activities, enhancing teamwork skills.
- **Supporter:** Provides emotional and academic support to fellow students.
- **Role Model:** Sets a positive example for others to follow.
- **Competitor:** Engages in healthy competition that motivates and drives academic performance.
- **Mentor:** Offers guidance and advice to peers, especially those who are younger or less experienced.
- **Friend:** Builds strong, supportive friendships that contribute to a positive school experience.
- **Conflict Resolver:** Helps mediate and resolve disputes among classmates.
- **Study Partner:** Collaborates on studying and homework, enhancing understanding and retention of material.
- **Encourager:** Motivates and encourages peers to persevere and succeed.
- **Communicator:** Facilitates open communication and dialogue within the classroom.
- **Team Member:** Participates actively in group activities and projects.
- **Listener:** Provides a listening ear for voters' concerns and challenges.
- **Innovator:** Brings new ideas and perspectives to group discussions and projects.
- **Cultural Ambassador:** Shares and promotes cultural awareness and diversity.

- **Problem Solver:** Works with peers to find solutions to academic and social challenges.
- **Leader:** Takes on leadership roles in group activities and projects.
- **Organiser:** Helps organise group activities and ensures tasks are completed efficiently.
- **Cheerleader:** Celebrates peers' successes and achievements.
- **Advisor:** Offers advice and support on academic and personal issues.
- **Peer Tutor:** Assists classmates in understanding and mastering difficult concepts.

Diversity of The Classroom Catchment Area i)

Economic Statuses

Resource Access: Students and teachers from higher-income families often have access to more educational resources, such as private tutoring, advanced technology, and extracurricular activities.

Financial Stress: Those from lower-income households might face financial stress, which can affect their academic performance and engagement.

Health and Nutrition: Economic disparities can influence students' nutrition and overall health, impacting their ability to concentrate and learn effectively.

ii) Family and/or Home Types

Single-Parent Households: Students from single-parent families may experience different levels of support and stability compared to those from two-parent households.

Extended Families: Living with extended family members can influence social dynamics and responsibilities, affecting students' time and focus on schoolwork.

Foster Care: Students in foster care may face unique challenges and require additional support to thrive academically and socially.

iii) Ethnic Origins

Cultural Perspectives: Diverse ethnic backgrounds bring a variety of cultural perspectives, enriching classroom discussions and learning experiences.

Language Barriers: Students from different ethnic origins may face language barriers that affect communication and learning.

Cultural Practices: Understanding and respecting different cultural practices and traditions is essential for fostering an inclusive classroom environment.

iv) Religious Affiliations and Beliefs

Diverse Beliefs: Students and teachers may practise different religions, bringing a variety of beliefs and practices into the classroom.

Holiday Observances: Recognizing and accommodating different religious holidays and observances is important for inclusivity.

Moral Values: Religious beliefs can influence students' moral values and behaviour, which teachers need to consider in their interactions and curriculum planning.

v) Rural Areas

Resource Limitations: Students from rural areas may have limited access to educational resources and technology.

Travel Distances: Long travel distances to school can affect attendance and punctuality.

Community Ties: Strong social ties in rural communities can provide a supportive network for students.

vi) Urban Areas

Diverse Populations: Urban areas typically have more diverse populations, offering a wide range of experiences and perspectives.

Cultural Institutions: Proximity to museums, theaters, and other cultural institutions can enhance educational opportunities.

Social Issues: Urban students may be more exposed to social issues such as poverty, crime, and pollution, which can impact their educational experiences. **vii) Behaviours, Traditions,**

Practices

Cultural Norms: Different cultural norms and practices can influence classroom behavior and interactions.

Celebrations: Incorporating diverse traditions and celebrations into the school calendar promotes inclusivity.

Learning Preferences: Cultural backgrounds can influence preferred learning styles and approaches.

viii) Opinions, Ideas, Perceptions

Critical Thinking: Exposure to diverse opinions and ideas fosters critical thinking and openmindedness.

Respectful Dialogue: Encouraging respectful debate and dialogue helps students learn to articulate and defend their ideas.

Innovation: Varied perspectives can lead to innovative solutions and creative problem-solving. **ix)**

Personalities and Experiences

Introverts and Extroverts: Different personality types can influence participation and interaction in the classroom.

Life Experiences: Unique life experiences shape students' and teachers' perspectives and approaches to learning.

Resilience: Personal experiences with adversity can build resilience and influence attitudes towards challenges.

x) Expectations and Needs

Support Requirements: Some students may require additional support due to learning disabilities or language barriers.

Enrichment Opportunities: Others may need enrichment opportunities to challenge them academically.

Professional Development: Teachers have varying professional development needs and expectations for their students. **xi) Learning Styles**

Visual Learners: Some students learn best through visual aids such as diagrams, charts, and videos.

Auditory Learners: Others may prefer listening to lectures, discussions, and audio materials.

Kinesthetic Learners: Hands-on activities and movement-based learning are essential for kinesthetic learners. **xii) Abilities and Disabilities**

Physical Disabilities: Students and teachers with physical disabilities may require specific accommodations to participate fully in school activities.

Learning Disabilities: Recognizing and supporting students with learning disabilities through tailored instructional strategies.

Gifted and Talented: Providing enrichment opportunities for students who are gifted and talented to challenge them academically. **xiii) Language Proficiency**

Multilingual Students: Students who speak multiple languages can enrich the classroom with their linguistic skills.

English Language Learners (ELLs): Providing support for students who are learning English as an additional language.

Language Diversity: Celebrating and incorporating different languages into the curriculum to promote linguistic diversity. **xiv) Age Differences**

Age Range: Classrooms may include students of varying ages, especially in mixed-grade settings.

Maturity Levels: Different maturity levels can affect classroom interactions and learning needs. Peer

Learning: Older students can mentor younger ones, fostering a collaborative learning environment.

xv) Socio-Political Views

Diverse Political Beliefs: Students and teachers may hold a range of socio-political views, contributing to rich discussions and debates.

Respectful Dialogue: Encouraging respectful dialogue about socio-political issues to promote critical thinking and understanding.

Civic Engagement: Teaching students about civic responsibility and encouraging active participation in their communities.

xvi) Technological Access

Digital Divide: Addressing disparities in access to technology and the internet among students.

Tech-Savvy Students: Leveraging the skills of tech-savvy students to enhance learning for all.

Digital Literacy: Ensuring all students develop essential digital literacy skills for the modern world.

xvii) Health Conditions

Chronic Illnesses: Supporting students and teachers with chronic illnesses through accommodations and understanding.

Mental Health: Promoting mental health awareness and providing resources for those in need.

Health Education: Incorporating health education into the curriculum to promote overall well-being.

xviii) Extracurricular Interests

Sports Enthusiasts: Students and teachers with a passion for sports can contribute to a vibrant school sports culture.

Arts and Music: Encouraging participation in arts and music programs to foster creativity and expression.

Clubs and Organisations: Supporting a variety of clubs and organisations to cater to diverse interests and talents.

xix) Migration Backgrounds

Immigrant Families: Students from immigrant families may face unique challenges, such as adapting to a new culture and language.

Refugee Students: Refugee students may have experienced trauma and require additional emotional and academic support.

Cultural Adjustment: Helping students adjust to new cultural norms and expectations in the school environment.

xx) Educational Backgrounds

Varied Educational Experiences: Students may come from different educational systems, affecting their readiness and approach to learning.

Previous Schooling: Differences in previous schooling experiences can influence students' academic skills and confidence.

Educational Gaps: Addressing gaps in knowledge and skills for students who may have had interrupted or inconsistent education.

4.1(b) The Social Relationships and Outcomes in the classroom

1. Teacher-Student Relationships

Formal social relationships between teachers and students are foundational to the classroom environment. These relationships are characterized by respect, clear communication, and structured interactions. Teachers set expectations, provide guidance, and offer feedback, which helps students understand their roles and responsibilities. Positive teacher-student relationships can lead to improved academic performance, increased motivation, and a greater sense of security and belonging for

students. When students feel supported and valued by their teachers, they are more likely to engage actively in their learning and exhibit positive behaviors.

2. Peer Relationships

Formal peer relationships in the classroom are often structured through group work, collaborative projects, and peer assessments. These interactions help students develop essential social skills such as cooperation, communication, and conflict resolution. Formal peer relationships can enhance learning by allowing students to share diverse perspectives and support each other academically. Positive peer interactions contribute to a supportive classroom climate, where students feel comfortable participating and expressing their ideas. These relationships also foster a sense of community and belonging, which is crucial for emotional well-being.

3. Teacher-Parent Relationships

Formal relationships between teachers and parents are vital for student success. Regular communication through parent-teacher conferences, progress reports, and school events helps keep parents informed about their child's academic progress and behavior. These interactions allow teachers to gain insights into students' home environments and tailor their support accordingly. Strong teacher-parent relationships can lead to better student outcomes, as parents are more likely to reinforce learning at home and collaborate with teachers to address any challenges. This partnership ensures a consistent and supportive approach to education.

4. Student-Administration Relationships

Formal relationships between students and school administration are essential for maintaining a well-organized and disciplined school environment. Administrators set policies, enforce rules, and provide resources to support both teachers and students. Formal interactions, such as assemblies, disciplinary meetings, and student council activities, help students understand the school's expectations and their role within the school community. Positive relationships with administrators can enhance students' sense of belonging and respect for school authority, contributing to a more orderly and focused learning environment.

5. Teacher-Administration Relationships

Formal relationships between teachers and school administration are crucial for effective school management and professional development. Administrators provide teachers with guidance, resources, and support to improve their teaching practices. Regular meetings, evaluations, and professional development sessions help ensure that teachers are aligned with the school's goals and standards. Strong teacher-administration relationships foster a collaborative and supportive work environment, which can lead to improved teaching quality and better student outcomes. When teachers feel supported by their administration, they are more likely to be motivated and committed to their professional growth.

6. Student-Counselor Relationships

Formal relationships between students and school counselors are important for addressing students' academic, emotional, and social needs. Counselors provide guidance on academic planning, career choices, and personal issues. Regular counseling sessions and workshops help students develop coping strategies, set goals, and navigate challenges. Positive relationships with counselors can lead to improved mental health, better academic performance, and enhanced personal development.

7. Teacher-Teacher Relationships

Formal relationships between teachers involve collaboration, professional development, and mutual support. Teachers work together to plan lessons, share resources, and discuss best practices. These interactions help create a cohesive and effective teaching team, which can improve the overall quality of education. Strong teacher-teacher relationships also provide emotional support and reduce feelings of isolation, contributing to a positive work environment.

8. Student-Student Mentor Relationships

Formal mentor relationships between students involve older or more experienced students providing guidance and support to younger or less experienced peers. These relationships can be structured through mentoring programs, peer tutoring, or buddy systems. Mentors help mentees navigate academic challenges, develop social skills, and build confidence. Positive mentor relationships can enhance students' sense of belonging, improve academic performance, and foster leadership skills.

9. Teacher-Community Relationships

Formal relationships between teachers and the community involve partnerships with local organizations, businesses, and community members. These relationships can provide additional resources, support, and learning opportunities for students. Community involvement in schools can enhance students' real-world learning experiences, promote civic engagement, and strengthen the school's connection to the broader community.

10. Student-Extracurricular Advisor Relationships

Formal relationships between students and extracurricular advisors are important for students' development outside the classroom. Advisors oversee clubs, sports teams, and other extracurricular activities, providing guidance and support. These relationships help students develop leadership skills, pursue their interests, and build a sense of community. Positive interactions with advisors can enhance students' overall school experience and contribute to their personal growth.

4.1(c) Roles and Activities in a School Classroom

Roles of a pupil in the classroom i) Learner

Continuous Learning: Pupils are always in a learning mode, whether in the classroom or outside, absorbing knowledge from teachers, peers, and their environment.

Active Participation: They are expected to actively engage in classroom activities and discussions.

Academic Performance: Pupils aim to achieve good grades and perform well in their classwork.

Skill Development: They develop various skills through different learning activities.

Adaptability: Pupils learn to adapt to different teaching styles and learning environments. **ii)**

Self-Evaluator

Self-Assessment: Pupils assess their own abilities and performance, forming self-images such as smart or dumb, fast or slow.

Comparison with Peers: They compare their performance with that of their classmates.

Behavioural Reflection: Pupils reflect on their behaviour, considering if they are trouble-makers, latecomers, or attentive.

Goal Setting: Based on self-evaluation, they set personal academic and behavioural goals. Self-

Improvement: Pupils strive to improve their weaknesses and build on their strengths.

iii) Self-Coordinator

Time Management: Pupils ensure they keep to school schedules and manage their time effectively.

Organization: They organize their learning materials, such as books and pens, for daily school activities.

Responsibility: Pupils take responsibility for their belongings and ensure they are well cared for.

Preparation: They prepare for classes by having all necessary materials ready.

End-of-Day Routine: At the end of the school day, pupils gather their materials and ensure nothing is behind.

iv) Conformist

Obedience: Pupils obey the teacher and adhere to classroom rules and regulations.

Classwork Compliance: They complete classwork as directed by the teacher.

Group Norms: Pupils conform to the unwritten norms of the classroom group, promoting harmony.

Respect for Authority: They show respect for the teacher's authority and the established classroom order.

Contribution to Stability: By conforming, pupils help maintain a stable and conducive learning environment.

v) Clique Leader

Leadership Recognition: Some pupils are recognized as leaders by a small group of peers.

Influence: They influence their followers more than the teacher in certain situations.

Role Models: Clique leaders can be outstanding athletes, adventurous individuals, or those with strong personalities.

Potential Disruption: If their leadership interferes with teaching, it can disrupt classroom welfare.

Authority Challenge: Teachers and school authorities may need to address and manage clique leaders to restore order.

4.1(d) The Teaching Activity

i) Design Schemes of Work

- **Curriculum Alignment**: Ensures that the teaching plan aligns with the national or school curriculum standards.
- **Long-Term Planning**: Provides a roadmap for the entire term or academic year, outlining what will be taught and when.
- **Resource Identification**: Helps in identifying the resources needed for each topic, such as textbooks, digital tools, and supplementary materials.
- **Learning Objectives**: Clearly defines the learning objectives for each unit, helping teachers focus on key outcomes.
- **Assessment Planning**: Integrates assessment methods to evaluate student progress throughout the course.

ii) Prepare Daily Lessons

- **Detailed Planning**: Breaks down the schemes of work into daily lessons with specific objectives and activities.
- **Engagement Strategies**: Includes methods to engage students, such as interactive activities, discussions, and multimedia resources.
- **Differentiation**: Plans for differentiated instruction to meet the diverse needs of all students.
- **Time Management**: Allocates time for each part of the lesson to ensure all content is covered efficiently.
- **Assessment Integration**: Incorporates formative assessments to gauge student understanding during the lesson.

iii) Interact with Pupils through Material Delivery

- **Instructional Methods**: Utilises various teaching methods, such as lectures, demonstrations, and hands-on activities, to deliver content.

- **Student Engagement:** Encourages active participation through questions, discussions, and collaborative work.
- **Feedback Provision:** Provides immediate feedback to students to help them understand and correct their mistakes.
- **Adaptability:** Adjusts teaching methods based on student responses and needs during the lesson.
- **Use of Technology:** Integrates technology, such as interactive whiteboards and educational software, to enhance learning.

iv) Assess the Pupils on Their Performance

- **Formative Assessments:** Uses quizzes, classwork, and observations to monitor ongoing student progress.
- **Summative Assessments:** Conducts exams and standardised tests to evaluate overall student performance at the end of a unit or term.
- **Feedback Mechanism:** Provides detailed feedback on assessments to guide student improvement.
- **Performance Tracking:** Maintains records of student performance to identify trends and areas needing attention.
- **Self-Assessment:** Encourages students to assess their own work and reflect on their learning.

v) Manage Class Equipment and Materials for Teaching-Learning Activities

- **Resource Organisation:** Ensures that all teaching materials and equipment are wellorganised and easily accessible.
- **Maintenance:** Regularly checks and maintains equipment to ensure it is in good working condition.
- **Efficient Use:** Plans the use of materials to maximise their effectiveness in supporting learning activities.
- **Inventory Management:** Keeps an inventory of classroom supplies and replenishes them as needed.
- **Safety Considerations:** Ensures that all equipment and materials are used safely and appropriately.

vi) Judge Achievement of the Classroom Goal

- **Goal Setting:** Establishes clear, measurable goals for student learning and classroom performance.
- **Progress Monitoring:** Regularly assesses student progress towards these goals through various assessment methods.
- **Outcome Evaluation:** Evaluates the extent to which the classroom goals have been achieved at the end of a term or unit.
- **Reflective Practice:** Reflects on the effectiveness of teaching strategies and makes adjustments as needed.
- **Student Feedback:** Gathers feedback from students to understand their perspectives on goal achievement.

vii) Create an Atmosphere Conducive to Learning

- **Positive Environment:** Fosters a positive and inclusive classroom environment where students feel safe and respected.
- **Classroom Management:** Implements effective classroom management strategies to minimise disruptions and maintain focus on learning.
- **Motivation Techniques:** Uses various techniques to motivate students and encourage a love for learning.

- **Emotional Support:** Provides emotional support to students, helping them feel valued and understood.
- **Physical Environment:** Arranges the physical classroom space to be conducive to learning, with appropriate seating, lighting, and resources.

viii) Punish and Reward for Undesirable and Desirable Behaviour

- **Behavioral Expectations:** Clearly communicates the rules and expectations for behavior in the classroom.
- **Positive Reinforcement:** Rewards desirable behaviors with praise, rewards, or privileges to encourage their repetition.
- **Consequences for Misbehavior:** Implements appropriate consequences for undesirable behaviors to maintain discipline.
- **Consistency:** Applies rules and consequences consistently to ensure fairness and predictability.
- **Behavioral Interventions:** Uses interventions and support strategies to help students improve their behavior.

ix) Assess the Teachers' Methods of Teaching

- **Self-Reflection:** Regularly reflects on teaching practices to identify strengths and areas for improvement.
- **Peer Observation:** Participates in peer observations to gain feedback and new perspectives on teaching methods.
- **Student Feedback:** Collects feedback from students to understand their experiences and perceptions of teaching effectiveness.
- **Professional Development:** Engages in continuous professional development to stay updated with the latest educational practices.
- **Teaching Evaluations:** Undergoes formal teaching evaluations by school administrators to ensure adherence to educational standards and goals.

LESSON 5

SOCIAL STRATIFICATION AND SCHOOL EDUCATION

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, learners should be able to:

Define social stratification

Give examples of social stratification in schools in Kenya

State how equality can be achieved in the education system in Kenya

5.1 Definition of Social Stratification

Social stratification refers to the presence of social groups that are ranked one above the other usually in terms of the amount of power, prestige, rewards and wealth that their members possess

Steep Pyramid Structure

Traditional Agrarian Societies: Often exhibit a steep pyramid structure.

- Upper Class: Includes the elite and bourgeoisie.
- Middle Class: Divided into superior and petty bourgeoisie.
- Working Class: Consists of skilled and unskilled workers.
- Base: Unemployed individuals.

Diamond Shaped Structure

Modern Western Societies: Typically have a diamond-shaped structure.

- Upper Class: Elites such as businessmen and industrialists.
- Upper Middle Class: Professionals and politicians.
- Lower Middle Class: Majority of the population, including administrators, teachers, doctors, and skilled manual workers.
- Lower Class: Unskilled manual workers and casual laborers

Two Class Structure

Marxian Conception: This structure divides society into two main classes.

- Capitalist Class (Bourgeoisie): Owns the means of production and exploits the working class by paying them less than the value of their labor.
- Working Class (Proletariat): Sells their labor to the bourgeoisie and is exploited in the process.

Polarization: Society is seen as increasingly divided into these two hostile classes.

Three or More Class Structures

Modern Western Societies: Typically have a more complex class structure.

- Upper Class: Consists of elites such as businessmen and industrialists.
- Middle Class: Includes professionals and politicians.
- Working Class: Comprises administrators, those in permanent employment, and skilled manual workers.
- Under Class: Consists of unskilled manual workers, casual laborers, people in slum areas, those in illegal businesses, and asylum seekers.

5.2 Theories on Social stratification of education

Status Theory

Status theory posits that individuals in society hold different statuses, which influence their roles and the rewards or prestige they receive. Here are the key points:

Ascribed Status: These are statuses individuals are born into and do not earn through personal effort. Examples include:

- Nobility: Such as kings, queens, or aristocrats.
- Commoner: Being born into a non-noble family.
- Family Background: Being born into a business family, working class, or peasant family.
- Other Factors: Birth order (first-born or last-born), gender (girl or boy), and race (white or black), depending on societal significance.

Achieved Status: While not mentioned explicitly in your text, it's worth noting that achieved statuses are those earned through personal effort,

- such as becoming a doctor, lawyer, or athlete.

These statuses shape the roles individuals play in society and the recognition they receive.

Social Class Theory Marxism

Class Location: According to Marxist scholars, class is determined by an individual's position in the production process.

Classes: Different modes of production create different classes, such as:

- Bourgeoisie: Capitalist class owning the means of production.
- Petty Bourgeoisie: Middle class.
- Proletariat: Working class.
- Peasantry: Rural working class.
- Lumpen-Proletariat: Unemployed and marginalized groups.

Role of Education: In a capitalist society, education serves to:

- Produce a compliant working force.
- Propagate an ideology that legitimizes class differences.
- Provide necessary skills and inculcate attitudes that support the status quo.

Class Change: Marxist scholars believe class structures can change with societal transformations and may eventually disappear. **Functionalism**

Max Weber's Perspective: Weber's view on class differs from Marx's, focusing on life chances and economic interests.

Class Definition: According to Weber, a class is defined by:

- Shared life chances based on economic interests.
- Possession of goods and opportunities for income.
- Conditions of the commodity or labor markets.

Class Indices: Weber includes factors such as wealth, occupation, residence, education, and income in his class analysis, recognizing the importance of economic factors but not solely focusing on production relations.

5.3 Social stratification cases in the school set up

Social stratification significantly impacts education and the school setup, creating disparities that affect students' experiences and outcomes. Here are some key effects:

1. Access to Quality Education

- **Resource Disparities:** Schools in wealthier areas often have better facilities, more experienced teachers, and more educational resources compared to schools in poorer areas¹.
- **Funding Inequities:** Public schools in affluent neighborhoods receive more funding through local taxes, leading to better educational opportunities.

2. Curriculum and Instruction

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Differentiated Curriculum: Schools serving higher socio-economic status (SES) students may offer more advanced courses and extracurricular activities, while those in lower SES areas may focus more on basic skills.

- Teacher Expectations: Teachers may have higher expectations for students from higher SES backgrounds, which can positively influence their academic performance.

3. Student Performance and Achievement

- Achievement Gaps: There are often significant achievement gaps between students from different socio-economic backgrounds, with those from higher SES backgrounds generally performing better.
- Standardized Testing: Students from wealthier families tend to perform better on standardized tests due to access to test preparation resources and a more supportive learning environment.

4. Social and Emotional Development

- Self-Esteem and Motivation: Students from lower SES backgrounds may struggle with lower self-esteem and motivation due to perceived and actual inequalities in the school environment.
- Peer Relationships: Social stratification can affect peer relationships, with students from different backgrounds forming separate social groups.

5. Parental Involvement

- Engagement Levels: Parents from higher SES backgrounds are often more involved in their children's education, providing additional support and resources.
- Educational Support: Higher SES parents are more likely to have the time, knowledge, and resources to help with homework and school projects.

6. School Climate and Culture

- School Environment: Schools in affluent areas often have a more positive school climate, with lower levels of violence and bullying.
- Cultural Capital: Students from higher SES backgrounds bring cultural capital that aligns with the school's expectations, making it easier for them to succeed.

7. Educational Attainment and Future Opportunities

- Higher Education Access: Students from higher SES backgrounds are more likely to attend and complete higher education, leading to better job prospects and higher earnings.
- Career Opportunities: The quality of education and the network of contacts available to students from higher SES backgrounds can lead to better career opportunities.

8. Policy and Reform Implications

- Equity Initiatives: Addressing social stratification in education requires policies aimed at providing equitable resources and opportunities for all students.
- Targeted Interventions: Programs such as scholarships, tutoring, and after-school activities can help bridge the gap for students from lower SES backgrounds.

9. Health and Well-being

- Nutrition and Health Services: Students from lower SES backgrounds may have less access to nutritious food and health services, affecting their ability to learn¹.
- Mental Health: Economic stress and instability can impact the mental health of students from lower SES backgrounds, influencing their academic performance¹.

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10. Technological Access

- **Digital Divide:** Students from lower SES backgrounds may have limited access to technology and the internet, which are increasingly important for modern education.
Remote Learning: During events like the COVID-19 pandemic, students from lower SES backgrounds faced greater challenges in accessing remote learning resources.

11. Neighborhood Effects

- **Community Resources:** The quality of the neighborhood, including access to libraries, parks, and community centers, can influence educational outcomes.
- **Safety and Stability:** Students from safer and more stable neighborhoods are more likely to attend school regularly and perform better academically.

12. Teacher Quality and Retention

- **Experienced Teachers:** Schools in affluent areas are more likely to attract and retain experienced and highly qualified teachers.
- **Teacher Turnover:** Higher turnover rates in schools serving lower SES communities can disrupt the learning environment and negatively impact student achievement.

13. Extracurricular Activities

- **Participation Rates:** Students from higher SES backgrounds are more likely to participate in extracurricular activities, which enhance college applications and social skills.
- **Access to Programs:** These students have greater access to a variety of extracurricular programs, including sports, arts, and academic clubs.

14. Early Childhood Education

- **Preschool Access:** Higher SES children are more likely to attend high-quality preschools, providing a strong foundation for future learning.
- **Early Literacy:** These children are exposed to more books and literacy activities at home, which supports their academic development¹.

15. Parental Education Level

- **Educational Attainment:** Parents with higher education levels are more likely to value and support their children's education.
- **Homework Help:** These parents are better equipped to help with homework and provide academic guidance.

16. School Choice

- **Private and Charter Schools:** Higher SES families have more options for private and charter schools, which may offer better educational opportunities.
- **Residential Mobility:** These families can move to areas with better public schools.

17. Cultural Expectations

- **Value of Education:** Higher SES families often place a higher value on education, instilling this belief in their children.
- **Academic Pressure:** These families may exert more academic pressure, leading to higher performance.

18. Parental Networks

- **Social Capital:** Higher SES parents have stronger social networks that can provide information and opportunities for their children.
- **Advocacy:** These networks enable parents to advocate more effectively for their children's educational needs.

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19. Educational Aspirations

- **College Expectations:** Higher SES families are more likely to expect their children to attend college, influencing their academic trajectory.
- **Preparation:** These families invest in college preparation resources, such as test prep courses and college counseling.

20. Lifelong Learning

Adult Education: Higher SES individuals are more likely to engage in lifelong learning opportunities, further enhancing their skills and career prospects.

- **Professional Development:** Access to professional development and continuing education is more readily available to those from higher SES backgrounds.

These effects illustrate how social stratification influences various aspects of education and schooling, often perpetuating existing inequalities. Addressing these issues requires comprehensive policies and targeted interventions to ensure equitable educational opportunities for all students.

5.4 The Quest for Equality and Equity in the education system in Kenya

Achieving equality in Kenya's education system requires a comprehensive approach that addresses various socio-economic, cultural, and policy-related factors. Here are 20 ways to promote equality in education:

1. **Equitable Funding:** Ensure that educational resources and funding are distributed equitably, particularly to underserved and marginalized areas.
2. **Infrastructure Development:** Invest in building and maintaining school infrastructure in rural and low-income areas to provide a conducive learning environment.
3. **Teacher Training and Support:** Provide ongoing professional development and training for teachers to equip them with the skills needed to address diverse student needs.
4. **Incentives for Teachers:** Offer incentives to attract and retain qualified teachers in remote and underserved areas.
5. **Relevant Curriculum:** Develop a curriculum that is relevant to the local context and addresses the needs of all students, including those from marginalized communities.
6. **Inclusive Teaching Methods:** Promote teaching methods that are inclusive and cater to the diverse learning needs of students.
7. **Access to Technology:** Provide access to technology and the internet in all schools, ensuring that students from all backgrounds can benefit from digital learning resources.
8. **ICT Integration:** Integrate Information and Communication Technology (ICT) into the curriculum to enhance learning and teaching processes.
9. **Community and Parental Involvement:** Involve local communities in the management and decision-making processes of schools to ensure that educational initiatives are culturally relevant and supported.
10. **Parental Support:** Encourage and support parental involvement in their children's education through awareness programs and community initiatives.
11. **Scholarships and Bursaries:** Provide scholarships and bursaries to students from low-income families to reduce financial barriers to education.
12. **School Feeding Programs:** Implement school feeding programs to ensure that students have the nutrition they need to focus on their studies.

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- 13. **Support for Girls' Education:** Implement programs specifically aimed at supporting girls' education, addressing barriers such as early marriage and pregnancy.
- 14. **Gender-Sensitive Policies:** Develop and enforce gender-sensitive policies that promote equal opportunities for boys and girls in education.
- 15. **Inclusive Education:** Promote inclusive education practices that integrate students with disabilities into mainstream schools.
- 16. **Specialized Support:** Provide specialized support and resources for students with special needs to ensure they receive a quality education.

17. **Monitoring and Evaluation:** Collect and analyze data on educational outcomes to identify gaps and areas for improvement.
18. **Continuous Improvement:** Implement a system of continuous monitoring and evaluation to ensure that educational policies and programs are effective and equitable.
19. **Early Childhood Education:** Expand access to high-quality early childhood education programs to provide a strong foundation for future learning.
20. **Policy and Legislation:** Strengthen the implementation and enforcement of laws such as the Basic Education Act of 2013, which guarantees the right to education for all children.

LESSON 6

GENDER AND SCHOOL EDUCATION

Objectives

By the end of this lesson learners should be able to:

Define Gender

Give examples of gender inequality in schools in Kenya

State how gender equality can be achieved in the education system.

Definition of Gender

Sociologists and Social psychologists argue that while Sex refers to the biological characteristics by which human beings are categorized as „male“ „female“, or in rare instances „hermaphrodite“ (in which the biological characteristics of both sexes are actually or apparently combined)

Gender refers to the social and social-psychological attributes by which human beings are categorized as „masculine“, „feminine“ or „androgynous“ (in which the social –psychological characteristics of both genders are intentionally or unintentionally combined) (Jarvis and Jarvis 1999).

Ways gender inequalities are manifested in Kenya:

- **Educational Attainment:** Girls often have lower enrollment and higher dropout rates compared to boys, especially in rural areas.
- **Early Marriage:** Many girls are married off at a young age, which disrupts their education and limits their future opportunities
- **Gender-Based Violence:** Women and girls face high levels of gender-based violence, including domestic violence and sexual harassment.
- **Employment Opportunities:** Women are underrepresented in formal employment and often work in lower-paying, informal jobs.
- **Gender Pay Gap:** Women earn less than men for the same work, contributing to economic disparities.
- **Political Representation:** Women are underrepresented in political positions and decisionmaking roles.
- **Access to Healthcare:** Women, especially in rural areas, have less access to quality healthcare services.
- **Reproductive Health:** Limited access to reproductive health services and information affects women's health and autonomy.
- **Property Rights:** Women often face challenges in owning and inheriting property due to cultural and legal barriers.
- **Financial Inclusion:** Women have less access to financial services, including credit and banking.
- **Cultural Norms:** Traditional gender roles and cultural norms limit women's opportunities and reinforce gender inequalities.
- **Work-Life Balance:** Women are often expected to balance work with household and caregiving responsibilities, limiting their career advancement.
- **Education Quality:** Girls often receive lower quality education due to fewer resources and support in schools.
- **Leadership Roles:** Women are less likely to hold leadership positions in both public and private sectors.
- **Legal Protections:** Inconsistent enforcement of laws designed to protect women's rights exacerbates gender inequalities.
- **Access to Technology:** Women have less access to technology and the internet, which limits their educational and economic opportunities.
- **HIV/AIDS Impact:** Women are disproportionately affected by HIV/AIDS, impacting their health and socio-economic status.
- **Agricultural Sector:** Women, who make up a significant portion of the agricultural workforce, have less access to land, resources, and training.

- **Social Services:** Women have less access to social services and support systems, which affects their ability to improve their socio-economic status.
- **Media Representation:** Women are often underrepresented or stereotypically portrayed in media, influencing public perceptions and reinforcing gender biases.

These manifestations highlight the multifaceted nature of gender inequalities in Kenya and underscore the need for comprehensive strategies to address them

The Quest for Gender Equality in Kenya Education systems

Promoting gender equality in Kenya requires a comprehensive approach that addresses various socioeconomic, cultural, and policy-related factors. Here are 20 specific and straightforward ways to promote gender equality:

Enforce Existing Laws: Strengthen the implementation and enforcement of laws that protect women's rights and promote gender equality.

Equitable Education: Ensure equal access to quality education for girls and boys, including scholarships and bursaries for girls from low-income families.

Combat Gender-Based Violence: Implement and support programs to prevent and respond to gender-based violence, including providing support services for survivors.

Economic Empowerment: Promote women's economic empowerment through access to credit, financial services, and entrepreneurship training.

Political Representation: Increase women's representation in political and decision-making positions through affirmative action and capacity-building programs.

Healthcare Access: Improve access to healthcare services for women, including reproductive health services and maternal care.

Property Rights: Ensure women have equal rights to own and inherit property through legal reforms and awareness campaigns.

Workplace Equality: Enforce laws and policies that promote equal pay for equal work and prevent workplace discrimination.

Support for Working Mothers: Provide support for working mothers, such as affordable childcare services and maternity leave.

Community Engagement: Engage communities in promoting gender equality through awareness campaigns and education programs.

Cultural Change: Challenge and change harmful cultural norms and practices that perpetuate gender inequality, such as early marriage and female genital mutilation.

Legal Aid: Provide legal aid and support services for women to help them navigate the legal system and protect their rights.

Media Representation: Promote positive and diverse representations of women in media to challenge stereotypes and change public perceptions.

Technology Access: Increase women's access to technology and the internet to enhance their educational and economic opportunities.

Mentorship Programs: Establish mentorship programs for girls and young women to support their personal and professional development.

Gender-Sensitive Policies: Develop and implement gender-sensitive policies in all sectors, including education, health, and employment.

Support for Survivors: Provide comprehensive support services for survivors of gender-based violence, including counseling, legal aid, and safe shelters.

Research and Data Collection: Conduct research and collect data on gender issues to inform policies and programs.

Partnerships: Foster partnerships between government, civil society, and the private sector to promote gender equality.

Public Awareness: Increase public awareness about gender equality through campaigns, workshops, and community dialogues

By addressing these areas, Kenya can work towards creating a more equitable society where all individuals, regardless of gender, have equal opportunities to succeed.

LESSON 7 DRUG ABUSE IN SCHOOLS

Objectives

By the end of this chapter, learners should be able to:

Define drug abuse and list some of the drugs abused in schools in Kenya

List factors that contribute to drug abuse in schools in Kenya

State the effect of drug abuse in Kenya and
Give suggestions on how drug abuse can be stopped in the society in general
and schools in particular

1.1 Definition a drug and drug abuse

A drug is any chemical substance that, when taken into the body, can affect one or more of the body's functions.

These include substances that are useful or harmful to the body. Drugs can be divided into three simple types; positive, negative and hard drugs. Positive drugs are those accepted by society. They can be bought easily from shops, chemists, herbalists, hospitals or any other community based health centre. They are used to cure ailments. Negative drugs are drugs taken for pleasure or for making someone feel „high”. Some of these drugs are socially accepted but their effect on the user is a slow drive to permanent addiction. Examples of some these drugs are; alcohol, Tobacco, Khat (miraa) and glue. Hard drugs are chemically made to stimulate the user and one becomes „hooked” to the habit and soon begins to show dependence on the drugs. These drugs include Bhang, opium, heroin, mandrax and cocaine

Drug abuse refers to the use of drugs for purposes other than therapeutic ones. In therapeutic use, drugs have intended effects aimed at relieving certain symptoms while the subject abusing drugs takes them to experience some effects associated with them. This may lead to dependence where the subject takes the drug on a continuous or periodic basis in order to experience the psychic effect or to avoid the discomfort of not taking the drug. Not only do unpleasant physical symptoms occur when the drug is withdrawn, but the body habituates itself to the drug's effect and larger and larger doses are required. Psychologically, the addict is unable to face life and its problems without the drugs.

Commonly abused drugs in Kenya

1. **Heroin:** Misuse: Injected, snorted, or smoked for its euphoric effects. Highly addictive, leading to severe health problems and risk of overdose.
2. **Cocaine:** Misuse: Snorted or smoked for its stimulant effects. Can cause severe cardiovascular issues and addiction.
3. **Methamphetamine:** Misuse: Smoked, snorted, or injected for its stimulant effects. Highly addictive, causing severe physical and mental health issues.
4. **Ecstasy (MDMA):** Misuse: Taken orally for its euphoric effects. Can lead to dehydration, hyperthermia, and long-term cognitive issues.
5. **Synthetic Cannabinoids:** Misuse: Known as “spice” or “K2,” these are chemically altered substances mimicking marijuana. Can cause severe health issues, including psychosis and heart problems.
6. **Tramadol:** Misuse: A prescription painkiller taken without prescription or in higher doses. Can lead to addiction and health complications.
7. **Diazepam (Valium):** Misuse: A sedative used medically but often misused for its calming effects. Misuse can lead to dependency and severe withdrawal symptoms.
8. **Ketamine:** Misuse: An anesthetic used recreationally for its dissociative effects. Can cause severe mental health issues and physical harm.
9. **LSD (Acid):** Misuse: A hallucinogen used for its mind-altering effects. Can lead to long-term psychological issues and dangerous behavior.
10. **Prescription Drugs (General):** Misuse: Includes painkillers, sedatives, and stimulants taken without prescription or in higher doses. Can lead to addiction, health complications, and overdose.

11. **Glue:** Misuse: Inhaled for its intoxicating effects, commonly by street children. Leads to severe health issues like brain damage.
12. **Inhalants:** Misuse: Substances like petrol and paint thinners inhaled for their psychoactive effects. Can cause sudden death, brain damage, and other severe health problems.
13. **Shisha (Hookah):** Misuse: Smoking flavored tobacco through a water pipe. Prolonged use can lead to respiratory diseases and addiction.
14. **Chang'aa:** Misuse: An illicit homemade alcoholic brew often consumed in excess. Leads to alcohol poisoning and health issues.
15. **Traditional Liquor:** Misuse: Brews like busaa and muratina consumed in social settings. Excessive consumption can lead to addiction and health problems.
16. **Potable Spirits:** Misuse: Commercially produced spirits often consumed in excess. Overconsumption can lead to addiction and health issues.
17. **Alcohol:** Misuse: Excessive drinking, underage drinking, and binge drinking. Can lead to addiction and health issues.
18. **Tobacco:** Misuse: Heavy smoking. Can cause respiratory diseases and addiction.
19. **Miraa (Khat):** Misuse: Prolonged chewing. Can lead to dependency and health problems like insomnia and oral issues.
20. **Bhang (Marijuana):** Misuse: Regular use. Can impair cognitive functions and lead to mental health issues.

Understanding these substances and their effects is crucial for developing effective prevention and intervention strategies in schools.

Deliquescent subcultures

Delinquent sub-cultures are groups that develop their own values and norms in opposition to mainstream society. Here are some examples:

Delinquent sub-cultures are groups that develop their own values and norms in opposition to mainstream society. Here are some examples:

1. **Gangs:** Characteristics: Often found in urban areas, gangs engage in criminal activities such as drug trafficking, theft, and violence. They have their own codes of conduct, symbols, and initiation rituals.
2. **Drug Sub-Cultures:** Characteristics: These groups revolve around the use and distribution of illegal drugs. Members share a common lifestyle centered on drug consumption, often developing their own language and social networks.
3. **Punk Subculture:** Characteristics: Emerging in the 1970s, the punk subculture is known for its rebellious attitude, distinctive fashion, and music. It often rejects mainstream societal norms and values.
4. **Hooliganism:** Characteristics: Associated with aggressive and violent behavior, particularly in the context of sports events. Hooligans form groups that engage in fights and vandalism.
5. **Skinheads:** Characteristics: Originally a working-class youth subculture, some factions of skinheads have become associated with racist and violent behavior. They often have distinctive dress codes and music preferences.
6. **Graffiti Artists:** Characteristics: While not all graffiti artists are delinquents, some sub-cultures engage in illegal tagging and vandalism. They often operate in groups and have their own styles and codes.
7. **Cyber Delinquents:** Characteristics: Groups that engage in illegal online activities such as hacking, cyberbullying, and spreading malware. They often have their own forums and communication channels.

8. **Street Racing:** Characteristics: Involves illegal racing on public roads. Participants often modify their cars and form tight-knit communities with their own rules and events.
 9. **Outlaw Motorcycle Gangs:** Characteristics: These groups engage in criminal activities such as drug trafficking and violence. They have a strong sense of brotherhood and loyalty, with distinctive symbols and rituals.
 10. **Youth Gangs:** Characteristics: Often formed in response to social and economic marginalization, these gangs engage in various forms of delinquency, including theft, vandalism, and violence⁴.
 11. **Skateboarding Subculture:** Characteristics: While not inherently delinquent, some groups within this subculture engage in trespassing and vandalism to access skate spots.
 12. **Rave Culture:** Characteristics: Associated with electronic dance music events, some participants engage in illegal drug use and unlicensed parties.
 13. **Graffiti Crews:** Characteristics: Groups that engage in illegal tagging and graffiti, often competing for territory and recognition
 14. **Street Gangs:** Characteristics: Involved in various criminal activities such as robbery, drug dealing, and violence. They have distinct symbols, colors, and initiation rites⁴.
 15. **Biker Gangs:** Characteristics: Outlaw motorcycle gangs involved in criminal activities like drug trafficking and extortion. They have a strong sense of brotherhood and loyalty.
 16. **Cyber Gangs:** Characteristics: Groups that engage in illegal online activities such as hacking, identity theft, and cyberbullying.
 17. **Prison Gangs:** Characteristics: Formed within prisons, these gangs control illegal activities inside and outside prison walls, including drug trafficking and violence⁴.
 18. **Neo-Nazi Groups:** Characteristics: Far-right extremist groups that promote hate crimes and violence based on racist ideologies⁴.
 19. **Anarchist Groups:** Characteristics: Groups that reject all forms of government and authority, sometimes engaging in violent protests and vandalism.
 20. **Cult Groups:** Characteristics: Some cults engage in illegal activities such as fraud, abuse, and violence, often under the influence of a charismatic leader⁴.
- These examples illustrate the diversity of delinquent sub-cultures, each with its own unique characteristics and behaviors that deviate from mainstream societal norms.*

Characteristics of deliquescent sub cultures

- 1 **Peer Pressure:** Strong influence from peers to engage in drug use.
- 2 **Rebellion Against Authority:** Defiance of school rules and authority figures.
- 3 **Secretive Behavior:** Concealing drug use and related activities from teachers and parents.
- 4 **Alternative Norms:** Developing their own set of norms that justify drug use.
- 5 **Drug Availability:** Easy access to drugs within or near the school environment.
- 6 **Group Identity:** Strong sense of belonging to the group, often marked by shared drug use.
- 7 **Risk-Taking:** Engaging in risky behaviors beyond drug use, such as truancy and vandalism.
- 8 **Poor Academic Performance:** Declining grades and lack of interest in schoolwork.
- 9 **Violence and Bullying:** Increased involvement in violent activities and bullying.
- 10 **Economic Activities:** Engaging in drug selling to support their habits or as a source of income.
- 11 **Distinctive Language:** Use of slang or coded language to discuss drug-related activities.
- 12 **Isolation from Mainstream Students:** Socially isolating themselves from students who do not use drugs.
- 13 **Health Issues:** Suffering from health problems related to drug abuse, such as respiratory issues or mental health disorders.

14 Frequent Absenteeism: High rates of absenteeism and skipping classes.

15 Family Problems: Often coming from dysfunctional family backgrounds.

16 Negative Role Models: Looking up to older students or community members who use drugs.

17 Substance Use Rituals: Specific rituals or routines associated with drug use.

18 Stigma and Marginalization: Facing stigma from the broader school community.

19 Lack of Future Aspirations: Little to no interest in future goals or career aspirations.

20 Involvement in Crime: Higher likelihood of engaging in criminal activities to sustain their drug use.

These features highlight the complex dynamics of delinquent sub-cultures in schools dealing with drug abuse in Kenya

Government Strategies to Curb drug abuse.

The Kenyan government has implemented several strategies to address the issue of drug abuse, particularly within delinquent sub-cultures. Here are some key approaches:

- **Legislation and Policy:** Enacting laws and policies to control the production, distribution, and consumption of drugs. The Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (Control) Act is a key piece of legislation.
- **Law Enforcement:** Strengthening law enforcement agencies to crack down on drug trafficking and related crimes. This includes the Anti-Narcotics Unit (ANU) which targets drug dealers and traffickers.
- **Public Awareness Campaigns:** Running nationwide campaigns to educate the public about the dangers of drug abuse. These campaigns often involve media, schools, and community organizations.
- **Rehabilitation Programs:** Establishing and supporting rehabilitation centers that provide treatment and support for individuals struggling with addiction.
- **Community Policing:** Encouraging community policing initiatives where local communities work with law enforcement to identify and address drug-related issues.
- **Youth Empowerment Programs:** Implementing programs aimed at empowering youth through education, vocational training, and employment opportunities to reduce the allure of drug-related activities.
- **Health Services:** Providing health services, including mental health support, to address the physical and psychological effects of drug abuse.
- **International Cooperation:** Collaborating with international organizations and neighboring countries to combat drug trafficking and share best practices.
- **School Programs:** Integrating drug education into school curriculums to inform students about the risks and consequences of drug use.
- **Support for Families:** Offering support services for families affected by drug abuse, including counseling and social services.
- **Research and Data Collection:** Conducting research to understand the scope of drug abuse and to develop evidence-based interventions.
- **Economic Initiatives:** Creating economic opportunities in high-risk areas to reduce the economic incentives for drug trafficking and abuse.
- **Legal Reforms:** Reviewing and updating legal frameworks to ensure they are effective in addressing current drug abuse challenges.
- **Harm Reduction Programs:** Implementing harm reduction strategies such as needle exchange programs and safe consumption spaces to reduce the health risks associated with drug use.

- **Training for Professionals:** Providing training for healthcare professionals, law enforcement, and social workers to better handle drug abuse cases.
- **Community-Based Interventions:** Supporting community-based organizations that work directly with affected populations to provide localized solutions.
- **Monitoring and Evaluation:** Regularly monitoring and evaluating the effectiveness of drug abuse interventions to make necessary adjustments.
- **Advocacy and Lobbying:** Working with advocacy groups to push for stronger policies and more resources to combat drug abuse.
- **Reintegration Programs:** Offering programs to help rehabilitated individuals reintegrate into society, including job placement and housing support.
- **Partnerships with NGOs:** Collaborating with non-governmental organizations that specialize in drug abuse prevention and treatment.

These efforts are part of a comprehensive approach to tackle the complex issue of drug abuse in Kenya